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Talks ‘minimal’ between Bears, Ill. legislators

Team remains focused on building stadium in Hammond, officials say

By Sean Hammond, Jeremy Gorner and Robert McCoppin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The Chicago Bears have had “minimal” discussions with Illinois legislators since the NFL franchise voted in June to focus its stadium efforts on northwest Indiana. Bears Chairman George McCas-

key and President/CEO Kevin Warren reiterated Thursday during a news conference at Halas Hall that the team remains focused on building a stadium over the state line in Hammond. Those efforts have zeroed in on two sites: the Lost Marsh Golf Course and the Wolf Lake Terminals. Warren said due diligence has been completed on the Lost Marsh

location and that it is viable for construction, while the process is ongoing at nearby Wolf Lake. A merger of the two sites also is possible, Warren said.

The team’s due diligence on the sites includes topographical, geological and environmental analysis of the land, Warren said, as well as putting together a “capital stack” to finance the \$2 billion the team has proposed to help build the stadium and a surrounding multi-use development. Both Warren and McCaskey used

the word “minimal” to describe ongoing communications with Illinois lawmakers this summer.

“I don’t know why it hit a dead end in Springfield,” Warren said. “But we’ve been very clear the last couple years the things that we’ve always needed is property tax certainty, we need infrastructure certainty. That’s what we’ve needed. So that has not changed.”

The Bears announced June 5 that their board of directors had voted to proceed with plans for a new stadium in Hammond. That

announcement came less than a week after the Illinois legislature adjourned for the summer without coming to a resolution on last-ditch efforts in the House and Senate to keep the franchise in Illinois.

The bill that passed through the House would have allowed the Bears to negotiate a special tax payment with local government bodies in the Arlington Heights area instead of paying higher property taxes. The proposal in the Senate would have created a public finance

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The family and friends of Keith Young gather as Young’s casket is carried out of Philadelphia M.B. Church after his funeral on Thursday in the East Garfield Park neighborhood of Chicago. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA PHOTOS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Executive order gives midterms shot in arm

Vaccine action hands win to MAHA voters, attack line for Dems

By Ali Swenson
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — President Donald Trump pivoted the nation’s attention back to vaccines this week with an executive order that aims to scale back the childhood immunization schedule and space out shots into separate visits.

After acting to overhaul the nation’s vaccine policy and guidance, the Trump administration had recently largely stepped back from additional changes to focus on less controversial subjects, raising questions over the political impetus behind and implications of the Republican president’s renewed focus on vaccines.

For well over a decade, Trump has expressed his view, against medical groups’ guidance, that childhood vaccines should be administered in smaller doses over a long period of time. The executive order sought to bear out that discredited theory.

While the move could endear Trump to some “Make America Healthy Again” voters who want more flexibility on immunizations, it’s also already attracting attacks designed to hurt Trump’s aligned candidates in November’s midterm elections.

Jayne Franklin, a 28-year-old conservative activist who appeared with the president to promote his executive order Monday, said she thinks the action is “going to go a long way” for MAHA mom voters like herself.

But Shaughnessy Naughton, president of the left-leaning political action committee 314 Action, which aims to elect doctors to office,

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‘RIGHT A WRONG’



A person holds memorial pamphlets for Keith Young during his funeral at Philadelphia M.B. Church on Thursday in the East Garfield Park neighborhood of Chicago.

Services delayed by discovery of 56 bodies at funeral home finally held

By Tess Kenny | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

They sang and they cried and embraced along the concrete steps of the church. They wore black and red, clutched carefully crafted programs and remembered their brother, their uncle, their cousin for his infectious laugh and compassion.

They said goodbye, just like they were supposed to six days ago.

After the funeral services for Keith Young were disrupted by the discovery of dozens of mishandled human remains at a South Deering funeral home, closure finally came for his loved ones this week. Packed into a small West Side Baptist church Thursday morning — the same church that relatives waited outside of last week for a body that never arrived —

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‘It’s time for a change’

Former Chicagoan Dan Sullivan takes on Alaskan senator with same name

By Rebecca Johnson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Dan Sullivan has always felt a visceral connection with strangers who share his name. Meeting them is fun. “Serendipitous” even.

For example, he said, he swapped family stories with a Dan Sullivan in line for TSA PreCheck in Chicago some years ago. An employee rattling off names had called for Dan Sullivan and they

both raised their hands.

Sullivan, who grew up in the south suburbs but now lives in Alaska, said he’s had the exact opposite experience when it comes to the Last Frontier’s junior senator — aka the other Dan Sullivan.

“(The senator) has a history of enacting programs and interacting with the public ... where if you disagree with me you’re part of some left-wing conspiracy to destroy Alaska,” he told the Tribune. “It just hit me a little harder than it would hit other people.”

So Sullivan, the one who said he still roots for both the White Sox and Cubs, launched his own

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Dan Sullivan, who has filed to run for the U.S. Senate in Alaska, stands June 26 in Petersburg, Alaska. **KATIE HOLMLUND/AP**

Trial lawyer running for school board president

Victor Henderson said stabilizing the district’s finances and setting up standing committees would be his priorities. **Chicagoland, A3**

Developer proposes replacing shuttered Ford City

A developer has resurfaced a proposal to replace Ford City Mall with a collection of warehouses and distribution buildings. **Business, B1**

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